helium were gradually drawn to the places where dark matter was the most dense, forming the first galaxies, stars, and everything else seen today.

We cannot see anything that happened during the first 300,000 years of the Universe. Scientists try to work it out from their knowledge of atomic particles and from computer models. The only direct evidence of the Big Bang itself is a faint glow in space, called cosmic microwave background.

As millions of years passed, the dense areas pulled in material because they had more gravity. Finally, about 100 million years after the Big Bang, the gas became hot and dense enough for the first stars to form. New stars were being born at a rate 10 times higher than in the present-day Universe. Large clusters of stars soon became the first galaxies.

The Hubble Space Telescope and powerful ground-based telescopes are now beginning to find galaxies that were created within a billion years after the Big Bang. These small galaxies were much closer together than galaxies are today. Collisions were common. Like two flames moving towards each other, they merged into bigger galaxies. Our Milky Way galaxy came together in this way.



Building Blocks Of Universe.

As stated above universe is constituted of galaxies, just as lot of houses in our locality constitute a village or a city. We have lot of things such as rooms, furniture etc. in our homes. Likewise lot of stellar objects such as stars, planets, asteroids and meteors are the building blocks of our universe.

More to know

Astronomical unit : The average distance between the Earth and the Sun is called an astronomical unit. It is denoted by 'au'.

$1 \text{ au} = 1.496 \times 10^8 \text{ km}$

Light year : The distance travelled by light in one year is called a light year. It is denoted by 'ly'.

$1 \text{ ly} = 9.4607 \times 10^{12} \text{ km}$

Parsec: A parsec is defined as the distance at which one astronomical unit subtends an angle of one arc second. It is denoted by 'pc'

$1 \text{ pc} = 3.2615 \text{ ly} = 3.09 \times 10^{13} \text{ km}$

Galaxies

A galaxy is a large collection of stars or cluster of stars and celestial bodies held together by gravitational attraction. There are about billions of galaxies in the universe. Most galaxies range from thousand to ten thousand parsec in diameter. As we have different types of houses in a locality, the galaxies are also of different types.

Types of Galaxies

There are various types of galaxies such as spiral, elliptical, barred spiral and irregular

Spiral Galaxy

Spiral galaxies consist of a flat, rotating disk containing stars, gas and dust, and a central

VII STD Science Term-3 EM unit 2.indd 31 29-08-2022 17:55:34